



RCCG OCEANIA

Relationships

MARRIAGE: SEASONS AND INTENTIONAL LOVE

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Marriage is a journey through various stages, each with its own challenges and joys. Like fine wine, it should become sweeter over time. By understanding the seasons of marriage and practicing intentional love, couples can navigate challenges and grow together spiritually and emotionally.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Ecclesiastes 3:1

John 2:1-11

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Marriage progresses through different seasons, each requiring unique approaches.
- The honeymoon stage is characterized by emotional love, but deeper, intentional love is necessary for longevity.
- Preparation and adaptability are crucial for navigating the reality and sacrifice stages of marriage.
- Spiritual fitness and personal growth are essential for overcoming marital challenges.
- Jesus' miracle at the wedding in Cana symbolizes the potential for marriage to improve over time.

INTRODUCTION

Marriage is a dynamic journey that unfolds through various stages, each bringing its own set of challenges and joys. By understanding these seasons and practicing intentional love, couples can navigate their relationship with grace and resilience, growing together both spiritually and emotionally.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Ecclesiastes 3:1** — Illustrates that life, including marriage, is in seasons, each with its own challenges and opportunities.
- **John 2:1-11** — Jesus' first miracle at a wedding highlights the transformative power of love and faith in marriage.

KEY POINTS

1. **UNDERSTANDING MARRIAGE SEASONS** — Marriage is not static; it evolves through various stages, each requiring different preparations and mindsets. Recognizing these seasons helps couples anticipate and adapt to changes. Just as nature has its seasons, so does marriage, each with its own beauty and challenges.
 - Identify the current season of your marriage and discuss it with your partner.
 - Reflect on past seasons and how they have shaped your relationship.
 - Prepare for upcoming seasons by setting mutual goals.

Scripture: Ecclesiastes 3:1

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

2. FROM EMOTIONAL TO INTENTIONAL LOVE — While the honeymoon stage is filled with emotional love, sustaining a marriage requires a shift to intentional love. This involves deliberate actions and commitments that go beyond feelings, focusing on nurturing and growing the relationship.
 - Practice daily acts of kindness towards your spouse.
 - Set aside regular time for meaningful conversations.
 - Develop rituals that reinforce your commitment to each other.
3. PREPARING FOR MARITAL CHALLENGES — Each stage of marriage, from reality to sacrifice, presents unique challenges. Couples must develop personal and spiritual fitness to navigate these effectively. This involves building resilience and a strong foundation of faith.
 - Engage in regular spiritual practices together.
 - Attend workshops or counseling to strengthen your relationship.
 - Discuss potential challenges and strategies to address them.

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **MARRIAGE AS FINE WINE** — Like fine wine, marriage should improve over time. This requires effort, understanding, and a commitment to grow together. Jesus' miracle at the wedding in Cana symbolizes the potential for transformation and improvement in marriage.

- Celebrate milestones and reflect on growth as a couple.
- Invest in activities that enhance your relationship.
- Embrace change as an opportunity for deeper connection.

Scripture: John 2:1-11

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What are some of the different seasons of marriage mentioned in Ecclesiastes 3:1?
- How did Jesus' miracle at the wedding in Cana impact the event?
- What characteristics define the honeymoon stage of marriage?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is it important to recognize the different seasons of marriage?
- How does intentional love differ from emotional love?
- What does the miracle at Cana teach us about transformation in marriage?

APPLICATION

- How can you and your spouse prepare for the next season of your marriage?
- What steps can you take to practice intentional love daily?

APPLICATION (CONT.)

- In what ways can you invite spiritual growth into your marriage?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom to recognize and understand the current season of your marriage.
- Ask for strength and commitment to practice intentional love daily.
- Seek guidance for spiritual growth together as a couple.
- Pray for resilience and unity in facing marital challenges.

NEXT STEP

Discuss with your spouse the current season of your marriage and set mutual goals for growth and intentional love.

CONCLUSION

Marriage is a journey that requires understanding, intentionality, and spiritual growth. By recognizing the seasons of marriage and committing to intentional love, couples can navigate challenges and celebrate the joys of their relationship, allowing it to mature and improve over time, much like fine wine.